



KNOW YOUR CUSTOMERS

UNBLOCKING THE RISKIEST PARTS OF YOUR BUSINESS

(with AI)



SAN DIEGO
STARTUP WEEK



About Rick Moy & Ryan Kuder



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Founder-CEO/CPO/CMO with multiple exits in B2B SaaS, Cloud, Cyber Security. Mentor, Board Member, Product Roundtable

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50-Minute Workshop Agenda

1. **Kickoff & Room Survey (5m)** – Quick show of hands: who's 0–1, MVP, post-launch, B2B SaaS, etc. + industries represented. Why customer truth makes or breaks startups (e.g. *Figma's early design partner loop* vs. *Clubhouse's fade*).
 2. **Stages & Lessons (10m)** –
 - 0–1 → Problem Discovery: *Notion's early "friends of friends" testers*
 - MVP → Customer Development/Creation: *Superhuman's PMF survey method*
 3. **The 100% customer. Definition & goal to approach 100%**
 - Post-launch weak traction → *Snapchat pivots* vs. *Houseparty stall*
 4. **Exercise 1 (10m)** – Write 3 riskiest assumptions on post-its, share in pairs.
 5. **Testing Playbook (10m)** – How to ask questions; traps to avoid.
 6. **Exercise 2 (10m)** – Groups design 1 question per assumption.
 7. **Wrap-Up (5m)** – 3 takeaways + commit to one test this week.
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Why Customer Discovery Matters

- 90% of startups fail due to lack of market need
- Assumptions about customers are often wrong
- Product-market fit requires deep customer understanding
- Early customer insights save time and resources
- Validates or invalidates your business hypothesis
- Helps prioritize features that truly matter
- Reduces risk of building something nobody wants



Common Mistakes in Customer Interviews

- Asking leading questions that confirm your bias
- Pitching your solution instead of listening
- Focusing on features instead of problems
- Not digging deep enough into pain points
- Talking to friends and family (not real customers)
- Asking hypothetical "would you" questions
- Ignoring negative feedback
- Interviewing too few people



The Right Approach to Customer Conversations

- Start with open-ended questions about their current situation
 - Listen more than you talk (80/20 rule)
 - Ask about past behavior, not future intentions
 - Focus on problems and pain points, not solutions
 - Use the "5 Whys" technique to dig deeper
 - Ask for specific examples and stories
 - Remain genuinely curious and neutral
 - Take detailed notes during the conversation
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Exercise 1

<insert crucial x known >



Key Questions to Ask

- "Tell me about the last time you experienced [problem]"
 - "What's the most frustrating part of your current process?"
 - "How do you currently solve this problem?"
 - "What would have to happen for this to be a priority?"
 - "Who else is involved in this decision?"
 - "What's the cost of not solving this problem?"
 - "Can you walk me through your typical day/workflow?"
 - "What have you tried before that didn't work?"
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Identifying Real Pain Points

- Look for emotional language and frustration
- Identify problems they're actively trying to solve
- Find pain points that cost time, money, or resources
- Listen for workarounds and manual processes
- Notice what keeps them up at night
- Distinguish between "nice to have" vs "must have"
- Look for problems that affect multiple people
- Validate pain points across multiple interviews



Turning Insights into Action

- Synthesize findings across all interviews
- Prioritize pain points by frequency and intensity [& willingness to pay]
- Create customer personas based on real data
- Map the customer journey and pain points
- Define your value proposition clearly
- Build an MVP focused on the biggest pain point
- Test your solution with the same customers
- Iterate based on feedback and validation & invalidation



Measuring PMF Progress

- Track customer retention and engagement rates
- Monitor Net Promoter Score (NPS) improvements
- Measure organic growth and word-of-mouth referrals
- Analyze customer acquisition cost trends
- Survey customers: "How disappointed would you be if this product disappeared?"
- Look for increasing usage frequency and depth
- Monitor customer support ticket trends
- Track revenue growth and customer lifetime value



Actionable Next Steps

- Start with 5-10 customer interviews this week
 - Create an interview script using the questions provided
 - Record and transcribe interviews for analysis
 - Look for patterns across multiple conversations
 - Build your first MVP based on the biggest pain point
 - Test your solution with interviewed customers
 - Iterate (Hypothesis & maybe some code) quickly based on feedback
 - Remember: Customer discovery is ongoing, not a one-time activity
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About UpSight

Customer Intelligence

Understand your
customers **like never
before**

Plan customer interviews, qualify real buyers, and extract insights — all in
one simple workflow.

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